

FRESH is an acronym for Focusing Resources on Effective School Health, an inter-agency framework developed by UNESCO, UNICEF, WHO, and the World Bank, launched at the Dakar Education Forum, 2000, which incorporates the experience and expertise of these and other agencies and organizations. It is a worldwide program for improving the health of school children and youth.

Core areas

Although aimed at improving learning opportunities for children and youths by first improving their health, FRESH is more than simply the provision of school health services. FRESH is a combination of activities in four core areas:

School health policies

Water, sanitation and the environment

Skills based health education

School-based health and nutrition services

There are three supporting strategies:

Effective partnerships between the education and health sectors

Community partnership

Student participation

Importance to UNESCO

The importance UNESCO attaches to this initiative can be seen from its introduction:

At the dawn of the 21st century, the learning potential of children and young people in every country in the world is compromised by conditions and behaviours that undermine the

physical and emotional well-being that makes learning possible. Hunger, malnutrition and micronutrient deficiencies, intestinal infections, infection with HIV and other sexually transmitted infections, malaria, violence, drug and alcohol abuse threaten the health and lives of the children and youth in which Education for All efforts are most invested.

A substantial body of evidence supports approaches in which policy development, health-promoting environmental change, skills-based health education and school-based health services are strategically combined to address priority health problems that interfere with learning for the targeted group. Such approaches extend the vision of health to include emotional/mental and psychosocial wellbeing as well as physical health.

Online tools

Reflecting the main themes of the program, online tools are available freely to all:

planning and evaluation

school health policies

water sanitation and the environment

school health services

HIV/AIDS

food and nutrition

parasitic worms and hygiene

malaria

violence

drugs, alcohol and tobacco

Global challenges

FRESH is linked to three global challenges:

Gender

Education for All (EFA) and Quality Education

Education for Sustainable Development (ESD)

See also

Free school meal

Personal, social, health and economic education

School dinner

School Health Education Study

School health services

References

External links

UNESCO

FRESH